Nephrolepis falcata

Fishtail Sword Fern, Fishtail Fern, Sickle Fern

Family: Nephrolepidaceae

Passage N_S: 1 **TOTAL 1**



HABIT



OTHER



LEAF



OTHER

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Evergreen fern

Evergreen or deciduous
Evergreen

Growth & Size
Rate: Moderate to fast in optimal conditions
Size: 1–3 ft (30–90 cm) × 2–3 ft (or larger in ideal conditions)

Sun

Water

Soil
Moist, well-drained, organically rich; slightly acid to neutral (pH ~5.0–7.0)

Zone 8a
Hardiness primarily reported for Zones 9–11. Outdoor performance in Atlanta Zone 8a not stated in primary ; may require protection, microclimate, or container culture with winter protection. Prefers high humidity and consistent moisture; hot, dry summers challenging without supplemental humidity/irrigation

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Humid tropical forests of Southeast Asia to northern Australia

Form
Dense rosette of arching fronds; distinctive forked (fishtail) pinnae tips. Distinctive fishtail pinnae morphology. Related to Boston fern (N. exaltata). vary slightly on exact hardiness; tropical origin emphasized. For Atlanta, treat as tender or container specimen

Foliage
Evergreen, pinnate fronds with sickle-shaped or forked leaflets; green, no significant fall color

Flowers and fruit
Non-flowering (fern); reproduces by spores and division

Bark
N/A (rhizomatous)

PLANTING NOTES

Establishment

Best in part shade, high humidity, consistently moist but well-drained organic soil. Excellent as houseplant, hanging basket, or in protected outdoor sites in warmer zones. Propagate by division. Avoid direct afternoon sun to prevent leaf burn. Maintain humidity for best appearance

HEALTH

Health

Pests: Mealybugs, scale, or other insects if humidity drops or plant stresses. Diseases: Root rot from overwatering/poor drainage. No major unique problems stated when cultural needs met. Non-toxic noted in some references

Symptoms

None stated